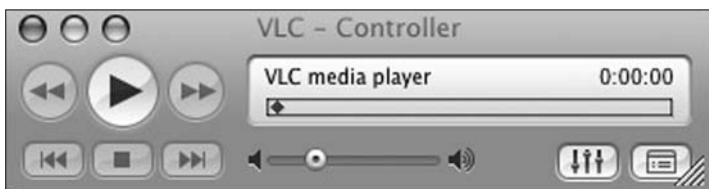


8.3 Multimedia

VLC

As you might know, VLC is a free, open source and a cross platform media player that supports a large number of video and audio formats. It was originally developed by students at the École Centrale, Paris, and was released under the GPL license in February 2001. However, today it is developed by a large number of contributors from all over the world.



The VLC controller window

VLC—or VideoLan Client—features a Mac-native Cocoa interface. However, it looks similar to its Windows counterpart. The only feature that it loses out on is skin support. VLC features skin support across all platforms except OS X.

As we said earlier, VLC supports a large number of video and audio formats including OGG, Vorbis, MPEG4, DVD video, Cinepak, DV, H.263, H.264, Indeo, WMA, WMV, AAC, AC3, AMR, ALAC, and more. From version 0.8.6, VLC also supports WMV9 videos natively, so you no longer need to use the age-old Windows Media Player or the slow and clumsy Flip4Mac plugin to play WMV9 files.

Cog

This is an open source and free audio player for OS X. It is developed by Vincent Spader, who is also the author of the brilliant audio conversion application called Max.

Cog is a simple audio player, and is a good alternative to iTunes. Over the years, iTunes has become a resource hog, and that's where Cog